



MENTOR ME

MentorME

Futura Remix Hackathon



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Build for Australia

AI Solutions for Industry and Communities

1. Hackathon Objectives

Australia is entering a period of significant workforce transformation as digital technologies and Artificial Intelligence (AI) reshape how organisations operate. While recent Australian Government research suggests that Generative AI is currently augmenting rather than replacing jobs, employers continue to face persistent workforce shortages, with the national vacancy fill rate remaining at only 68.2% in March 2026. These trends highlight a growing demand for graduates and professionals who can combine technical capability with critical thinking and practical problem-solving. (Australian Government, 2026; Jobs and Skills Australia, 2026).

Australia's higher education sector plays a critical role in developing this future workforce. Between January and May 2026, 680,582 international students studied in Australia, while Higher Education enrolments continued to grow despite broader declines across other education sectors. As student cohorts become increasingly diverse, universities are placing greater emphasis on career readiness, industry engagement and preparing graduates for an AI-enabled workforce. (Department of Education, 2026).

At the same time, AI is rapidly moving from experimentation to enterprise adoption. According to KPMG's Global Tech Report 2026, 53% of organisations report that they still lack the talent needed to deliver digital transformation successfully, while 92% believe managing AI agents will become an important workforce capability within the next five years. These findings demonstrate that future professionals will need more than technical knowledge. They must be able to apply AI responsibly to solve real-world challenges. (KPMG, 2026).

The MentorME Futura Remix Hackathon was created in response to these emerging opportunities. Through real-world Australian challenge statements, participants will tackle problems that reflect their own education, careers and communities while developing practical experience in AI, collaboration and innovation. By the end of the hackathon, participants will have strengthened their ability to identify meaningful problems, design user-centred solutions and build capabilities that are increasingly valued in Australia's future workforce.





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The Problem

1. Australia continues to attract global talent

680,582

International Student in Australia from Jan-May 2026

Source: Australian Government Department of Education (2026).

+2%

Higher Education enrolments compared to Jan-May 2025

-6.9%

Overall international students vs Jan-May 2025

2. Employer expectations are changing

69%

of Australian employer report difficulty finding skilled talent.

(ManpowerGroup, 2024)

92%

of technology executives believe AI capability will become an essential workforce skill within the next five years.

(KPMG Global Tech Report, 2026)



THE REAL CHALLENGE

Australia is not lacking talent
It is facing a growing gap between graduate capability and workforce expectations in an AI-enabled economy

Key Insights

680,582 international students studied in Australia between January and May 2026, while Higher Education enrolments continued to grow (+2% year-on-year). This reflects Australia's continued ability to attract highly educated international talent. (Australian Government Department of Education, 2026).

While 69% of Australian employers report difficulty finding skilled talent, 92% of technology executives believe AI capability will become an essential workforce skill within the next five years. This signals that employers are increasingly seeking graduates who can combine technical expertise with AI literacy and digital capability. (ManpowerGroup, 2024; KPMG, 2026).

Australian employers also face difficulties identifying transferable skills, evaluating international experience and connecting with suitably qualified candidates despite ongoing workforce shortages.



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The challenge is no longer attracting talent.
It is helping talent succeed.

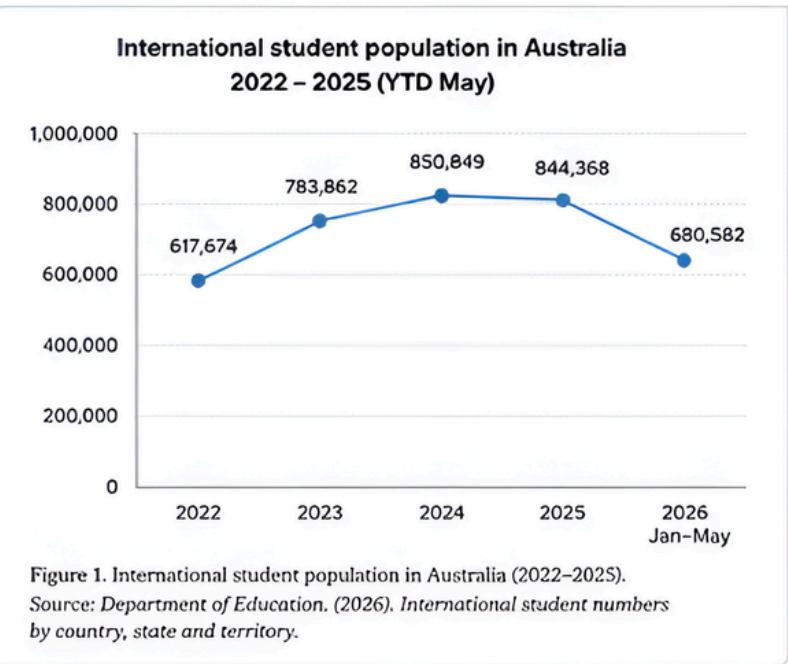
Challenge Tracks

TRACK 1 - Future of Work and International Talent

CHALLENGE QUESTION

How might we use AI, data and digital technology to help international students and skilled migrants access meaningful career opportunities, while helping Australian employers identify, develop and retain diverse talent?

CONTEXT



Australia continues to attract a growing international talent pool through its higher education system and skilled migration programs.

Between 2022 and 2024, the number of international students increased by approximately 38%, reaching more than 850,000 students nationwide.

While this growth contributes significantly to Australia's economy and workforce, it also increases the need for more effective pathways that help international talent transition successfully into employment.

THE PROBLEM



International talent face barriers

- Understanding local recruitment processes
- Translating overseas qualifications
- Building professional networks
- Gaining relevant Australian experience



Employers face challenges

- Identifying transferable skills
- Evaluating international experience
- Connecting with suitable candidates
- Retaining diverse talent



These issues create a disconnect between available talent and labour market demand.



YOUR CHALLENGE

Design an AI powered solution that improves employment outcomes for international talent while helping Australian organisations better identify, develop and retain skilled people.

Your solution should demonstrate clear value for users, be technically feasible and address a genuine workforce challenge in Australia

CHALLENGE AREAS

Participants may choose to focus on one or more of the following areas.



Career Navigation



Skills Recognition & Job Matching



Employability & Career Readiness



Employer Recruitment & Workforce Planning

EXAMPLE SOLUTION DIRECTIONS



AI Career Advisor

Personalised guidance on career pathways, roles and next steps.



Skills Translation Platform

Translate overseas skills and experience into Australian standards.



AI Employability Coach

Provide feedback on applications, interviews and job readiness.



Employer Matching Platform

Match talent with employers based on skills, potential and culture fit.



Workforce Analytics Dashboard

Real-time insights on talent pipelines, skills gaps and demand trends.



AI Onboarding Assistant

Support smoother onboarding and integration for international hires.

TRACK 2 - Education and Student Success

How might we use AI, data and digital technology to improve student learning, engagement, academic support and preparation for employment

Top 5 Challenges of Using AI in Education



As student cohorts become larger and increasingly diverse, universities face growing pressure to deliver personalised learning experiences, timely academic support and effective career preparation at scale. These changing expectations create opportunities for AI powered solutions that improve student engagement, learning outcomes and employability throughout the education journey.

- Accessing the right support at the right stage of their journey
- Support services operate across separate systems and teams
- Lack of connected, personalised experiences
- Changing needs not identified early



- Pressure to improve engagement, learning outcomes and employability
- Operating under financial and resource constraints
- More than 40% of universities in deficit over past five years
- Decline in funding per domestic student by 6% since 2017



These issues create a common challenge: how to identify students who need support earlier, deliver more personalised learning experiences and better prepare graduates for successful careers without proportionally increasing resources.



Design an AI powered solution that enhances student learning, engagement and academic success while strengthening career preparation and employability.

Your solution should demonstrate clear value for users, be technically feasible and address a genuine workforce challenge in Australia

Participants may choose to focus on one or more of the following areas.



Personalised Learning Pathways



Student Engagement
& Support



Academic Success & Wellbeing



Career Preparation & Employability

AI Student-Support Assistant

Conversational assistant that provides timely academic, wellbeing and admin support.



Personalised Learning Recommendation Platform

AI driven platform that recommends content, resources and activities based on learner needs.



**Student Engagement
& Early-Support
Dashboard**

Analytics dashboard that identifies at-risk students and enables early intervention.

Employability & Skills
Tracking Tool

Track skills, co-curricular activities and progress towards employability goals.



Mentoring Management System

Match students with mentors and manage conversations and milestones.



Portfolio & Career Readiness Platform

Help students build portfolios, showcase skills and prepare for future careers.



Challenge Guidelines

Challenge Expectations

Your team does not need to solve every part of the challenge. You should identify **one clear problem, one main target user** and a **realistic solution** that can be developed within the hackathon.

Strong submissions will demonstrate:

- A clearly defined user problem.
- Evidence that the problem is important.
- A focused and realistic solution.
- A working prototype or convincing proof of concept.
- A clear explanation of how the technology works.
- Consideration of implementation, privacy, fairness and accessibility.
- A measurable benefit for users, organisations or communities

Effective hackathon challenge briefs usually connect a broad issue with a specific user, local context, practical constraints and supporting resources. The humanitarian challenge uses individual personas and a clear problem scenario to guide participants. The ASEF challenge examples similarly move from a broad theme to a clearly defined local problem, target population and intended impact.

Teams should avoid relying on:

- Data that would not realistically be available.
- Unreasonable budgets.
- Technology that cannot be explained.
- Fully automated high-impact decisions without human review.

What Teams Can Build

Your solution may take the form of:

- An AI agent or assistant
- A web or mobile application
- A data analytics dashboard
- A recommendation or matching system
- An automation tool
- A predictive analytics solution
- A digital service or platform
- A working prototype supported by a clear implementation plan

Teams are encouraged to use AI, data and digital tools where they add genuine value. Using AI for the sake of including AI will not result in a higher score. Teams should clearly explain why the selected technology is appropriate for the problem.

Key Constraints

All teams should consider the following requirements.

Responsible use of AI and data

- Privacy and data protection
- Bias and fairness
- Transparency
- Security
- Appropriate human oversight
- Responsible use of personal and employment information

Accessibility and inclusion

Solutions should be usable by people with different:

- Cultural and language backgrounds
- Levels of digital confidence
- Education and professional experience
- Accessibility requirements

Practical implementation

Solutions should be realistic for an Australian employer, university, training provider or community organisation to implement.

Team Structure

Each team should include 4 to 5 participants
To reflect the vibe-coding nature of the hackathon, teams are strongly encouraged to split roles clearly.

Role	Suggested Number	Main Responsibility
Software Engineer / Vibe Coder	1-2	Build the prototype using AI coding tools, manage technical implementation, test core features and support the demo.
Business Analyst	1	Define the user problem, map requirements, clarify the workflow and make sure the solution solves the right problem.
Data Analyst / Data Scientist	1	Support data use, AI logic, analytics, evaluation, metrics, dashboarding or model-related decisions.
Business / Communication Lead	1	Shape the value proposition, prepare the pitch, explain impact, and communicate the solution clearly to the judges

Participants do not need to perfectly match these titles, but every team should make sure the following areas are covered:

- Product and problem understanding.
- Business value and communication.
- Technical build.
- Final pitch and demonstration.
- Data, AI or analytics thinking.

A strong team is not just a group of coders. A strong vibe-coding team combines problem understanding, AI-assisted building, validation, business thinking and clear communication.



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Submission Requirements

Each team must submit the following:

1. Problem statement

Clearly explain what problem you are solving, who experiences the problem and why the problem matters

2. Proposed solution

Explain what your solution does, who will use it and how it improves the current situation.

3. Prototype or proof of concept

This may include a working application, interactive prototype, dashboard, technical demonstration or validated product concept.

4. Technology overview

Explain the tools and technologies used, how the main components work together, what data or AI models are required and any important technical limitations.

5. Implementation plan

Explain how the solution could be introduced, which organisation or partner could use it, what resources would be required, and the key risks and next steps.

6. Impact measurement

Identify how success would be measured. Examples may include increased employment outcomes, improved job or skills matching, increased student engagement, reduced time to access support, better employee retention or improved user satisfaction.

7. Final pitch and submission

Teams must present their problem, solution, prototype and implementation approach to the judging panel.

Each team only needs to submit:

- Pitch slides (PDF or PPTX) covering the requirements above.
- A demo showcasing the prototype or proof of concept.

Pitch Format and Judging Criteria

First-round judging

Each team will receive:

- **5 minutes** for the pitch and demonstration.
- **5-10 minutes** for questions from the judges.

Teams should manage their time carefully. Judges may stop presentations that exceed the allocated time.

Recommended pitch structure

1. The problem.
2. The target user.
3. The proposed solution.
4. The prototype demonstration.
5. The technology.
6. The expected impact.
7. The implementation and next steps.

Projects will be assessed out of 100 points.

Criterion	Weight	What it focuses on
Problem and User Understanding	15%	• Clearly defines a specific problem and primary target user • Demonstrates understanding of real user needs or pain points • Shows why the problem matters and its relevance to the selected challenge track • Demonstrates understanding of the Australian context
Solution Quality and Innovation	15%	• Solution directly addresses the identified problem • Presents a clear and meaningful value proposition for the target user • Shows creativity or a meaningful improvement over existing approaches • Uses AI, data or digital technology in a relevant and purposeful way
Prototype and Technical Execution	35%	• Delivers a functional and convincing prototype or proof of concept demonstrating the core solution • Uses AI/vibe-coding tools effectively to build and iterate the solution • Demonstrates understanding and ownership of the technical approach and AI-generated outputs • Explains how key components, technologies and data work together • Demonstrates testing and awareness of key technical limitations or risks
Evaluation, Impact and Future Development	20%	• Clearly explains the business, education or community value created by the solution • Identifies meaningful and measurable indicators of success • Critically evaluates current limitations, risks and trade-offs • Considers privacy, fairness, security, accessibility and appropriate human oversight where relevant • Provides realistic implementation and next steps, with potential for further development or scale
Pitch and Live Demonstration	15%	• Communicates the problem, solution and value proposition clearly • Provides a smooth and convincing demonstration of the actual prototype/workflow • Clearly explains key technology and implementation decisions • Presents within the allocated time • Responds confidently and effectively to judges' questions
Total	100%	